

Phase 1 Corridor Report

Memory Rail / Breeze Morgue Rail update with screenshots and design notes

Repo	github.com/heggkj/darts-pats
Branch	phase-1-corridor-experience
Report path	public/reports/phase-1-corridor-report.pdf
Screenshots	public/reports/screenshots/
Generated	May 9, 2026

What Changed

- Replaced the idea of generic chapter navigation with a fixed tactile Memory Rail / Breeze Morgue Rail made of newspaper clipping tabs, drawer labels, stamped edges, and a small built-in year dial.
- Mapped the exhibit into seven chapters: Threshold, Walk the Years, The Friction Map, The Trouble Spots, Open the Drawer, Editor’s Table, and Reflection Wall.
- Added IntersectionObserver-driven active chapter state so the selected tab appears pulled out or edge-lit while visitors scroll or tap through the exhibit.
- Added Take me to my years: visitors choose 1991-2026 and pull the year to jump/filter the corridor near that year. It uses no login, saved state, score, or user content.
- Added small-screen behavior as a bottom object tray, preserving the tactile exhibit-object feel rather than becoming a standard mobile menu.
- Added IMAGE_ASSET_MANIFEST.md with the requested Memory Rail asset plan and Image 2 prompts.

Before / After Notes: Avoiding StoryMap Gravity

Before risk	A normal chapter sidebar, numbered dots, or clean content-block nav would make the exhibit feel like corporate scrollytelling or a map-adjacent presentation shell.
After direction	The rail is intentionally crooked, tactile, and object-like: clipped tabs, stamped labels, paper tape, glowing selected edges, and a year dial that feels pulled from an archive drawer.

Map language avoided	The Friction Map remains a bulletin-board station inside the exhibit. The navigation does not use map pins, map panels, route dots, or large white scrollytelling chapter cards.
Touch intent	Targets are large, persistent, and tap-first. The active state is physical selection, not hover decoration. The bottom tray keeps the same object metaphor on smaller screens.

Verification

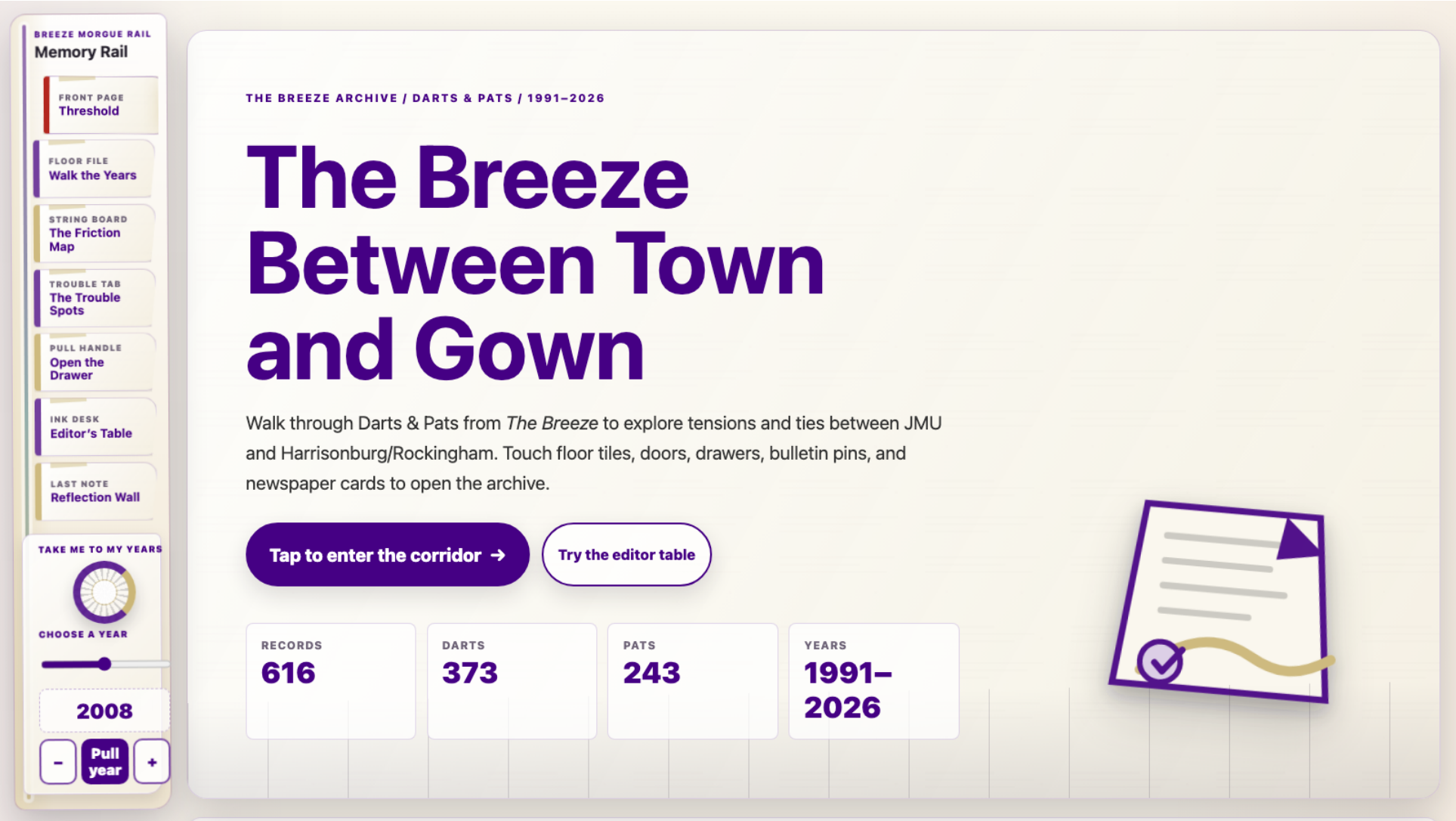
- npm run build passed.
- Production-style Playwright screenshots captured from built dist on a static local server.
- Rail click, active state, year jump, and small-screen tray were checked with no console warnings or errors during screenshot capture.

Screenshot Index

Screenshot	What it shows
Memory Rail at the threshold 01-memory-rail-threshold.png	The rail appears as a fixed stack of clipped tabs and labels, with the year dial mounted into the object rather than a normal site menu.
Active chapter state 02-active-friction-map-token.png	The Friction Map token is physically selected with a pulled tab, red edge, and glow while the bulletin-board network is in view.
Take me to my years 03-year-jump-memory-lane.png	The year dial jumps the corridor and timeline to 2002, filters the archive, and keeps the interaction unsaved and score-free.
Trouble Spots chapter tab 04-trouble-spots-tab.png	The rail can jump directly into the corridor topic stations without becoming a numbered chapter dot system.
Small-screen object tray 05-bottom-object-tray-small.png	On a narrower viewport, the rail becomes a bottom tray of physical objects instead of a mobile sidebar or hamburger menu.

Memory Rail at the threshold

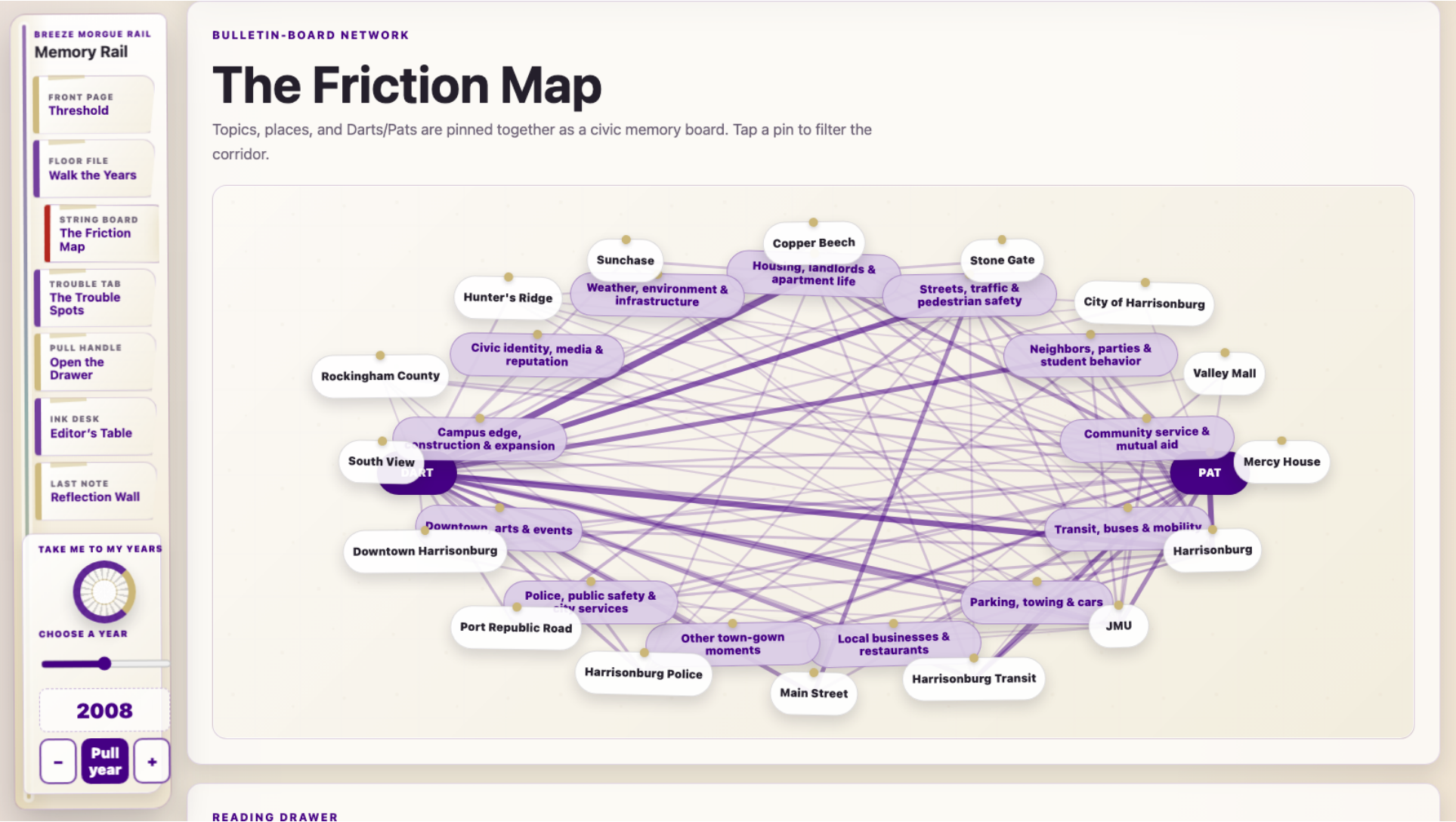
The rail appears as a fixed stack of clipped tabs and labels, with the year dial mounted into the object rather than a normal site menu.



Screenshot: public/reports/screenshots/01-memory-rail-threshold.png

Active chapter state

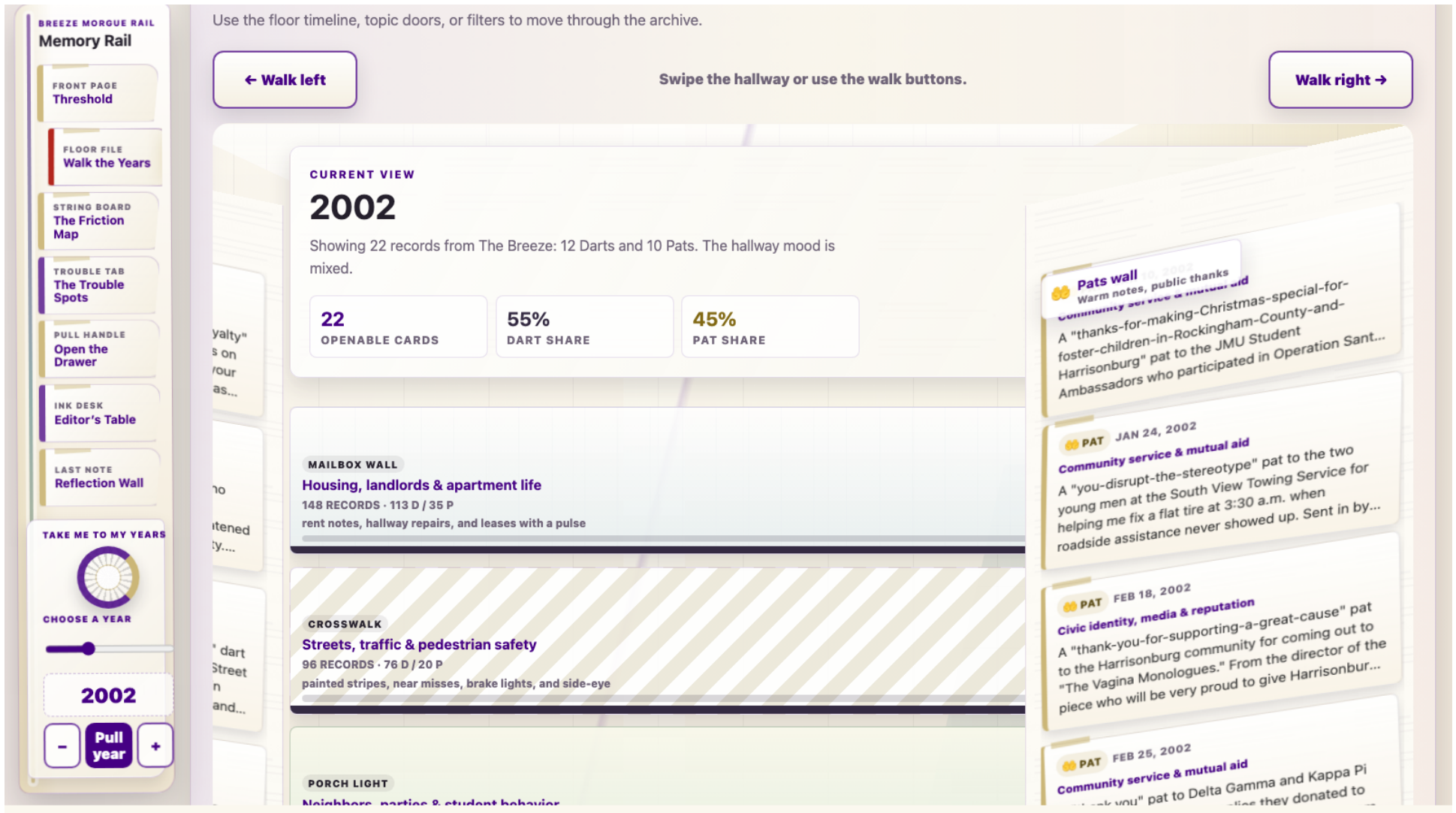
The Friction Map token is physically selected with a pulled tab, red edge, and glow while the bulletin-board network is in view.



Screenshot: public/reports/screenshots/02-active-friction-map-token.png

Take me to my years

The year dial jumps the corridor and timeline to 2002, filters the archive, and keeps the interaction unsaved and score-free.



Screenshot: public/reports/screenshots/03-year-jump-memory-lane.png

Trouble Spots chapter tab

The rail can jump directly into the corridor topic stations without becoming a numbered chapter dot system.

BREEZE MORGUE RAIL

Memory Rail

FRONT PAGE

Threshold

FLOOR FILE

Walk the Years

STRING BOARD

The Friction Map

TRouble TAB

The Trouble Spots

PULL HANDLE

Open the Drawer

INK DESK

Editor's Table

LAST NOTE

Reflection Wall

TAKE ME TO MY YEARS

CHOOSE A YEAR

2008

- Pull year +

MAILBOX WALL

Housing, landlords & apartment life

48 RECORDS · 113 D / 35 P

ent notes, hallway repairs, and leases with a pulse

CROSSWALK

Streets, traffic & pedestrian safety

16 RECORDS · 76 D / 20 P

ainted stripes, near misses, brake lights, and side-eye

PORCH LIGHT

Neighbors, parties & student behavior

12 RECORDS · 53 D / 19 P

oise, trash, parties, neighbors, and the morning after

VOLUNTEER TABLE

Community service & mutual aid

12 RECORDS · 10 D / 52 P

ign-up sheets, food drives, kids, care, and civic gratitude

BUS STOP

Transit, buses & mobility

19 RECORDS · 24 D / 25 P

outes, drivers, schedules, shelter, and shared dependence

PAT NOV 7, 1991

Community service & mutual aid

A candy-coated pat to the public-spirited members of the JMU cheerleaders and the men's and women's basketball teams who delayed their holiday to help kids celebrate Halloween at Valley...

PAT MAR 23, 1992

Community service & mutual aid

A real cool pat to WXJM for sponsoring Cool Aid, a unique showcase of JMU bands that benefited Mercy House. And much thanks to Johnnies Heritage, Succotash, the Dave Matthews Band,...

PAT MAR 26, 1992

Community service & mutual aid

A great big pat for the members of JMU's Animal Rights Coalition protesting the use of donkeys in a "donkey basketball" game at Broadway High School. Animals were not put on this Earth to be...

PAT APR 13, 1992

Civic identity, media & reputation

To the members of the predominately black Greek letter organization for all the community...

Screenshot: public/reports/screenshots/04-trouble-spots-tab.png

Small-screen object tray

On a narrower viewport, the rail becomes a bottom tray of physical objects instead of a mobile sidebar or hamburger menu.

The Breeze Between Town and Gown

Walk through Darts & Pats from *The Breeze* to explore tensions and ties between JMU and Harrisonburg/Rockingham. Touch floor tiles, doors, drawers, bulletin pins, and newspaper cards to open the archive.

Tap to enter the corridor →

Try the editor table

RECORDS

616

DARTS

373

FRONT PAGE
Threshold

FLOOR FILE
Walk the Years

STRING BOARD
The Friction Map

TROUBLE TAB
The Trouble Spots

PULL
Open



2008



Pull year



Screenshot: public/reports/screenshots/05-bottom-object-tray-small.png